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(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Walters et al.

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(54) **COREOPSIS PLANT NAMED ‘SUNBEAM’**

(50) Latin Name: ***Coreopsis verticillata***
Varietal Denomination: **Sunbeam**

(75) Inventors: **Ronald L. Walters**, deceased, late of
Hudsonville, MI (US); by **Sharon**
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(73) Assignee: **Walters Gardens Inc.**, Zeeland, MI (US)

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **11/894,824**

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(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/00 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.** **Plt./417**

(58) **Field of Classification Search** **Plt./417**
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

PP16,096 P2 * 11/2005 Croon **Plt./417**

* cited by examiner

Primary Examiner—Wendy C. Haas

(57) **ABSTRACT**

The new and distinct *Coreopsis verticillata* plant named
‘Sunbeam’ with narrow foliage, yellow flowers having
rounded apices and long flowering for cut flower, or land-
scaping in mass or as a specimen plant.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Coreopsis verticillata*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘Sunbeam’.

BACKGROUND OF THE PLANT

The present invention relates to the new and distinct
Threadleaf Coreopsis herein also referred to as *Coreopsis*
verticillata ‘Sunbeam’, by the cultivar name, ‘Sunbeam’, or
as the Plant. ‘Sunbeam’ was discovered by Ronald L.
Walters in the summer of 2002 as an uninduced whole plant
mutation of Coreopsis ‘Moonbeam’ (not patented) in the
fields of a wholesale perennial grower in Zeeland, Mich.,
USA. It was then isolated and compared in subsequent years
to other *coreopsis* and found to be different from all cultivars
known to the discoverer.

Asexual propagation at the same nursery in Zeeland,
Mich. USA by cuttings has shown ‘Sunbeam’ to be stable
and reproduce true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE PLANT

The Plant has not been observed in all possible environ-
mental conditions. The phenotype may vary slightly with
changes in environments such as light intensity, fertility,
water availability, etc. without, however any variation in
genotype.

‘Sunbeam’ is distinct from all known cultivars in the fol-
lowing traits:

1. Narrow foliage with moderate height.
2. Petite flowers held above the foliage with deep yellow
ray petals.
3. Long flowering period.

NEAREST COMPARISON

Plants of ‘Sunbeam’ are shorter in habit than ‘Golden
Showers’ (not patented) and taller than ‘Zagreb’ (not
patented). Flowers of ‘Sunbeam’ are smaller, with entire
margins on ray petals and the flowers are above the foliage

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compared to ‘Crème Brutée’ U.S. Plant Pat. No. 16,096
which have larger flowers held at the foliage level and
incised ray petal apices. The ray petal color of ‘Sunbeam’ is
slightly darker yellow than ‘Crème Brulée’.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The color photographs illustrate the overall characteristics
of the Plant. The colors are as true as reasonably possible
given the technology available. The color values may vary
slightly depending on light intensity and quality.

FIG. 1 shows the habit of the Plant in flower in mid sum-
mer.

FIG. 2 shows a close-up of the flower.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The following description is based on a two-year old plant
growing in a full-sun trial garden in Zeeland, Mich., USA.
For the growing season up to the time of description the
daytime temperatures range between 12–30° C., and night
temperatures range between 6–19° C. Except for ordinary
dictionary color usage, color references are according to The
Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2001 edition.

Parentage: Non-induced mutation of ‘Moonbeam’ (not
patented).

Asexual propagation: Cuttings, about 10 to 14 days to ini-
tiate roots; time to finish as #1 field grown, 9 months;

Plant habit: Freely basally and axillarily branched, rounded,
herbaceous perennial mound; 50 to 60 cm wide, 50 to 55
cm tall;

Leaves: Opposite, entire, glabrous, acute apex; base attenu-
ate; apetioli; up to 3 cm long and 2 mm wide: RHS 135A
on top and RHS 139A on lower surfaces;

Veins: Not obvious;

Flower: Composite consisting of ray and disc florets; on
terminal branches; 3.5 cm diameter, 1.0 cm tall from outer
set of involucre bracts to top of disc florets;

Sepals:
Phyllary: In two distinct whorls, outer whorl consisting of about 10, about 2 mm long, acute apex, narrowly deltoid, truncate base, glabrous, between RHS 144A and RHS 144B; inner whorl tight against ray petals, usually 8 in number, 5 mm long and 2 mm wide, acute apex and truncate base, closer to RHS 9B at apex and RHS 144A at base;
Fragrance: Not detected;
Flowering period: Early summer through early autumn; producing over 40 flowers per stem and over 200 flowers per plant;
Flower longevity: 5 to 8 days;
Flower buds: One to two days before showing ray petal color spherical with slightly flattened top, 4.0 mm wide and 4.0 mm diameter; near RHS 144B;
Peduncle; Glaucous, thin wiry, strong, many branched; 5.0 mm wide at base; RHS 147B;
Pedicel: Glaucous, thin, wiry, strong; less than 1 mm in diameter, 4 to 5 cm long, RHS 147B.
Ray florets: Usually 8 per flower; oblong elongate, apex rounded, margin entire; base narrowly cuneate; opening to form 180° angle; parallel veined; glabrous on both surfaces, 1.7 to 2.0 cm long and 6 to 7 mm wide; RHS 9A on both surfaces; corolla tube about 2.0 mm long; containing only gynoecium with style 2 to 3 mm long and split stigma; both style and stigma color closest to RHS 9A;

Disc florets: 30 to 60 per head; consisting of tepals, staminal tube and pistil;
Tepals: Five; 5 mm long and 1 mm wide, fused in the basal 4 mm, acute apex, color between RHS 151B and RHS 151A;
Staminal tube: Made up of five fused stamens, 2 to 3 mm long, RHS 174A;
Anther: About 1 mm long, closest to RHS 187A;
Pollen: Fine, round, closest to RHS 21C;
Style: About 4.5 mm long; RHS 160B;
Stigma: Split in half and curling back as it matures; RHS 160C;
Seed: Rarely observed.

‘Sunbeam’ is tolerant of winter temperatures as low as –20° C. and summer temperatures of 40° C. Tolerant of dry summer conditions but does best with ample moisture; Not known to be tolerant of diseases and pest that are common to other *Coreopsis* cultivars.

I claim:

1. The new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant named ‘Sunbeam’ as described and illustrated, with yellow un-fringed petals, fine thread-like foliage and long flowering period.

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Fig. 1



Fig. 2